

A TRUSTMRR DATA STORY

The Hidden Economics of Indie & Micro-SaaS Startups

What 1,000 self-reported startups reveal about where revenue, growth, and success actually concentrate — beneath the build-in-public narrative.

1,000

STARTUPS ANALYZED

\$13.5M

AGGREGATE MRR

60+

COUNTRIES

29

DATA FIELDS

Four Numbers That Define This Market

48%

of all revenue is earned
by the top 1% of startups

77%

average growth rate for the
largest startups vs. -2% for the smallest

5.7×

more monthly revenue for
B2B startups vs. B2C

40×

higher revenue for anonymous
“Stealth” startups vs. named ones

Broad Coverage on Financials, Real Gaps on Classification

1,000

Startups, 29 fields

60+

Countries represented

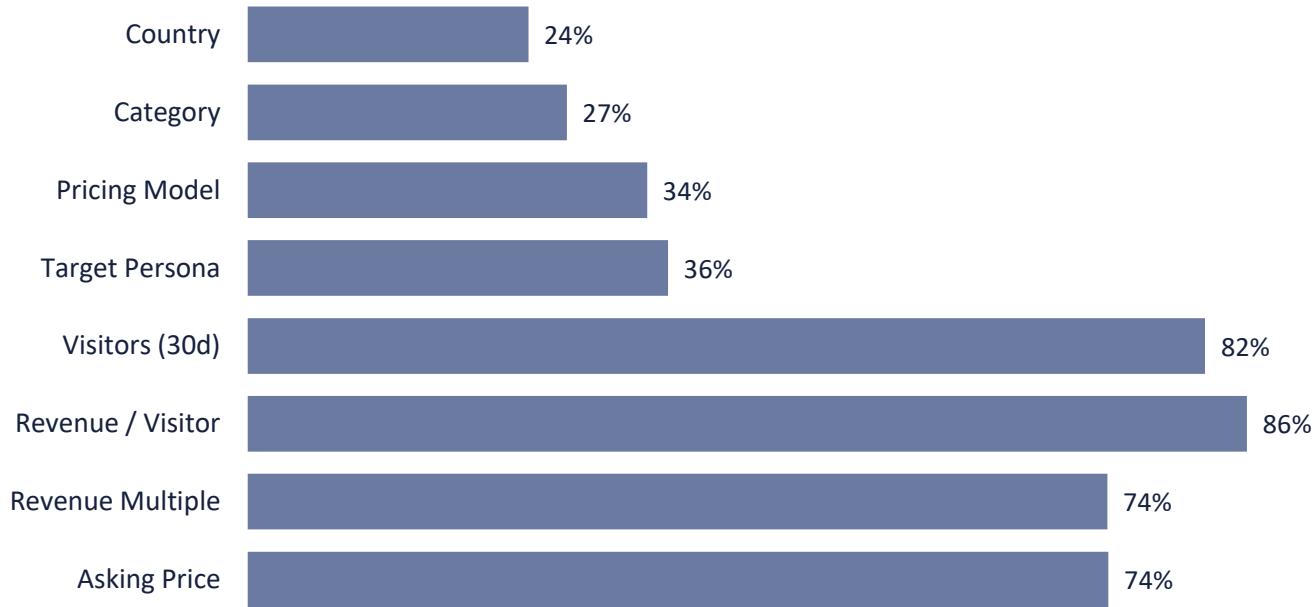
>98%

MRR & revenue coverage

73–76%

Category & country coverage

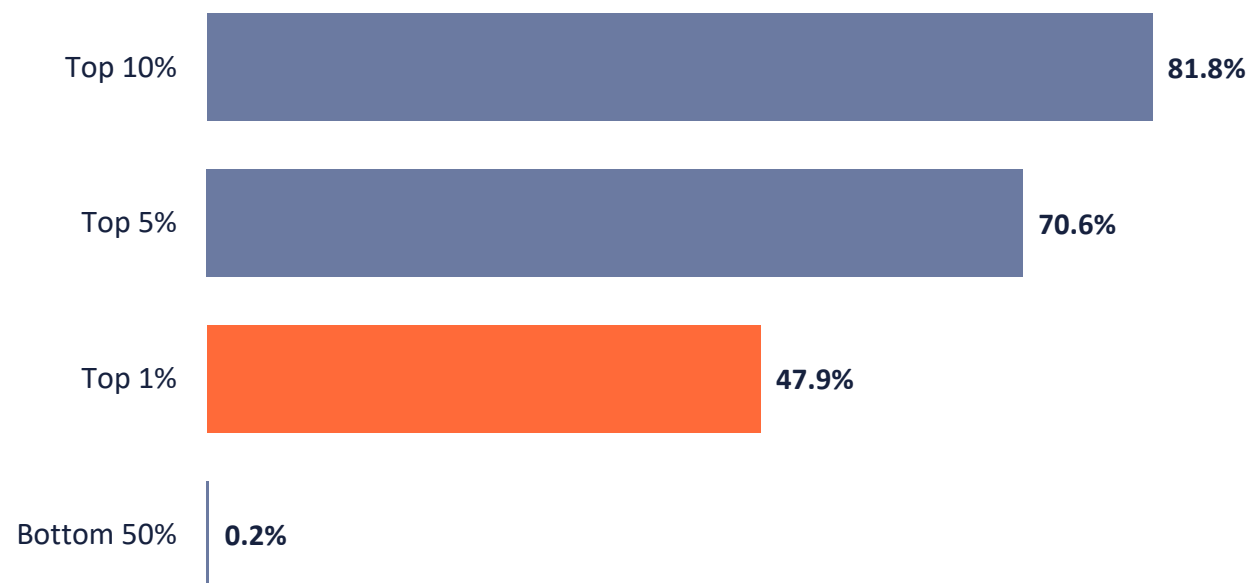
Missing Data by Field



Fields below 30% missing are treated as reliable; fields above are read directionally.

Ten Startups Earn Nearly Half the Market's Revenue

Share of Total MRR Captured



48%

of all MRR earned by just
10 startups (top 1%)

\$282

median monthly revenue
across the full sample

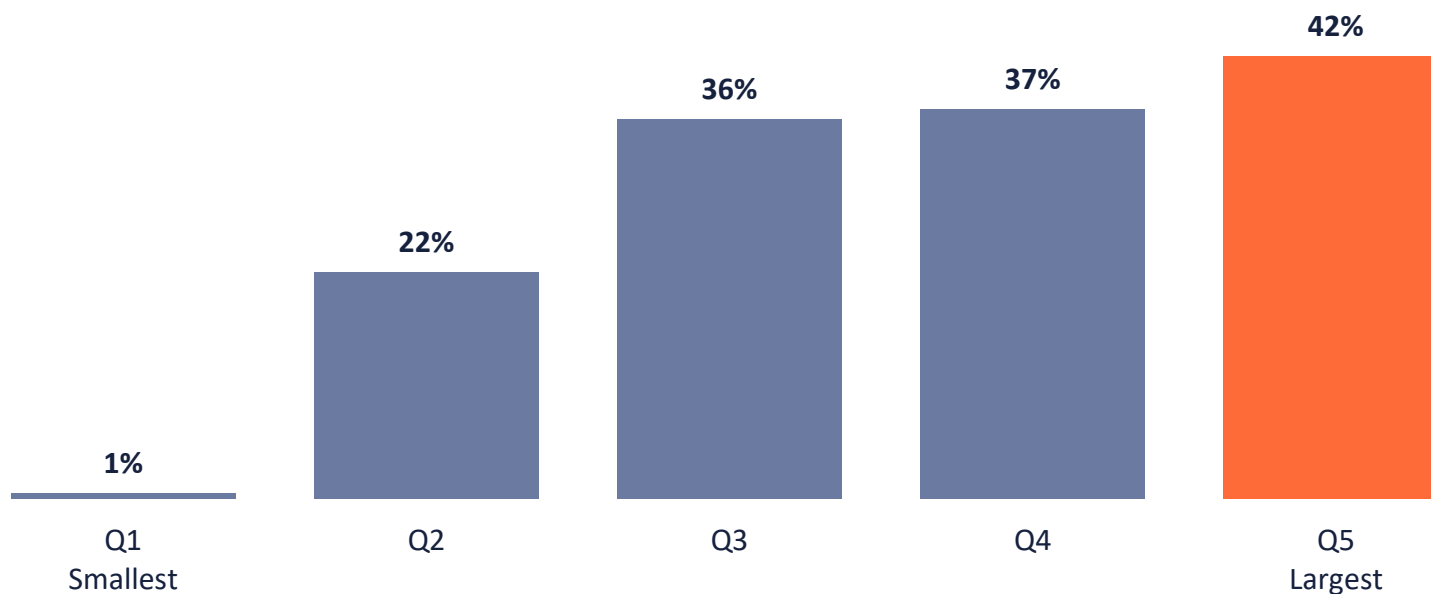
20%

of startups report
\$0 in MRR

Benchmark this market on percentiles — never on the mean.

Momentum Compounds With Scale, It Doesn't Fade

Share of Startups With Positive MRR Growth, by Size Quintile



77%

mean growth rate,
largest quintile

-2.3%

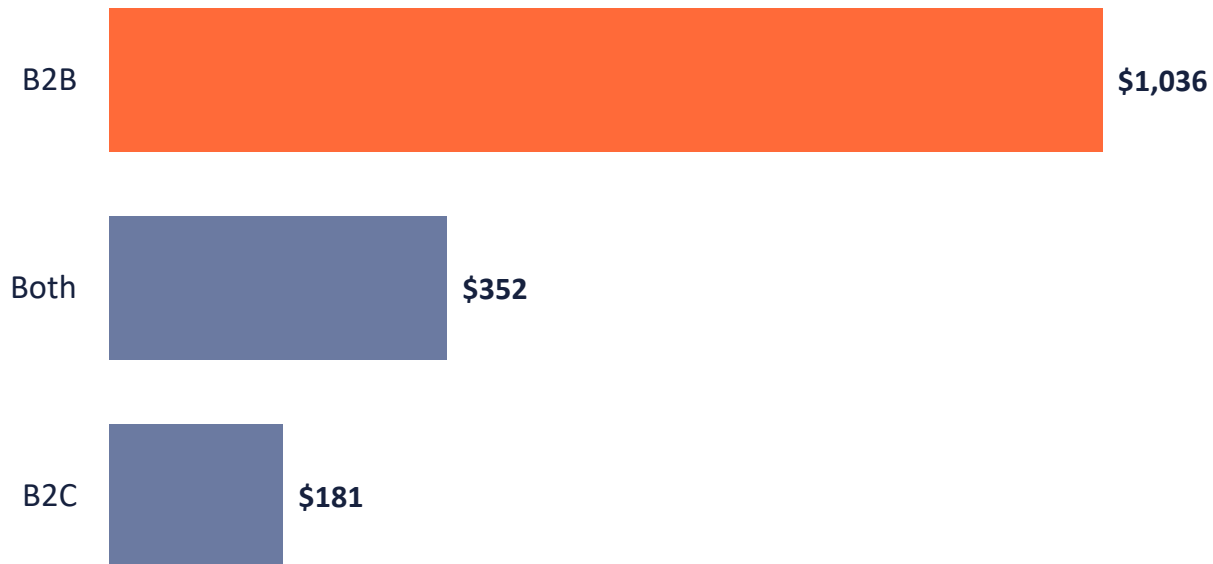
mean growth rate,
smallest quintile

84×

gap in growth
likelihood, Q5 vs Q1

B2B Startups Out-Earn B2C by 5.7×

Median Monthly Recurring Revenue by Audience



\$1,036

B2B median MRR

\$181

B2C median MRR

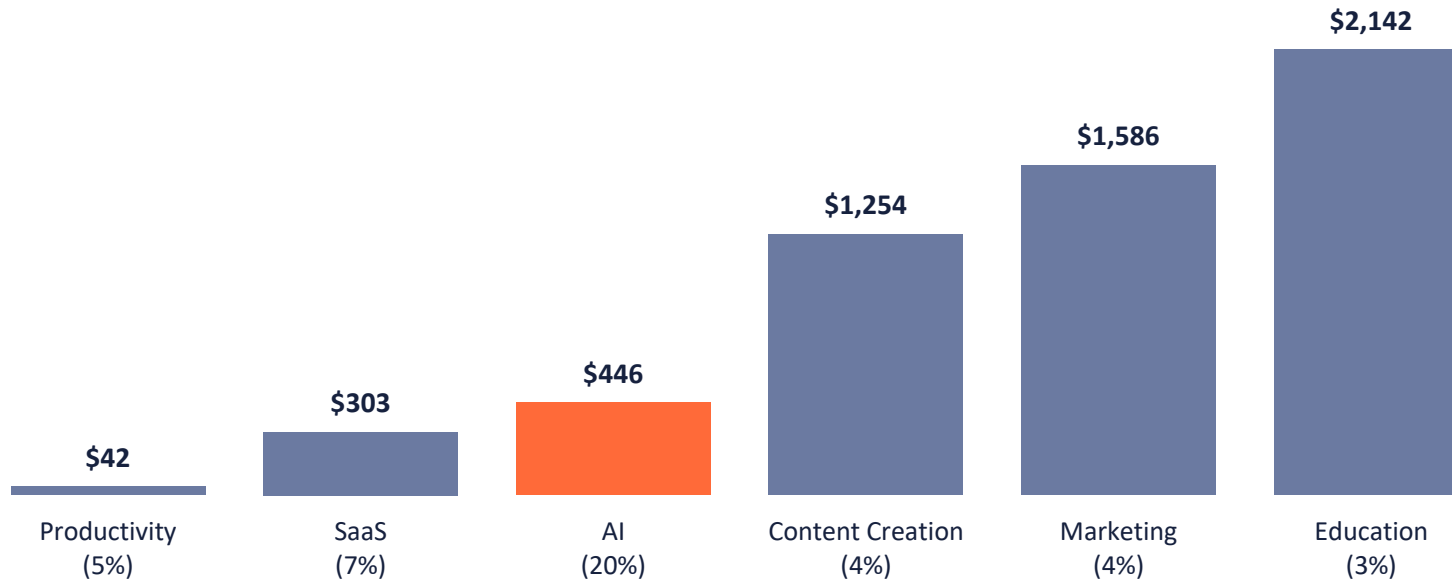
40%

share of sample
that is B2C (largest group)

AI Is the Most Crowded Category — Not the Best Paid

Median MRR by Category

(% share of dataset)



AI = 1 in 5 startups in the dataset, but ranks 5th of 6 on median revenue.

Search Authority Predicts Revenue Better Than Social Reach

Correlation With Monthly Recurring Revenue

Domain Rating (SEO)

0.47

X (Twitter) Followers

0.18

Correlation of $\log(\text{metric})$ vs. $\log(\text{MRR})$, both variables where populated.

2.6×

stronger predictor of revenue:
domain authority vs. followers

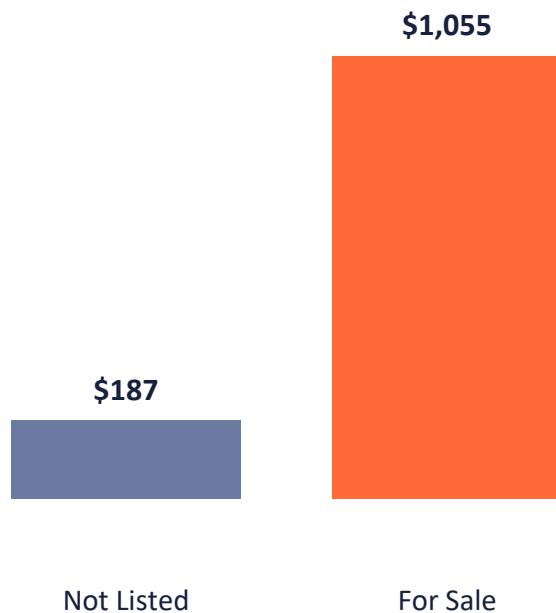
0.47

correlation: domain rating → MRR

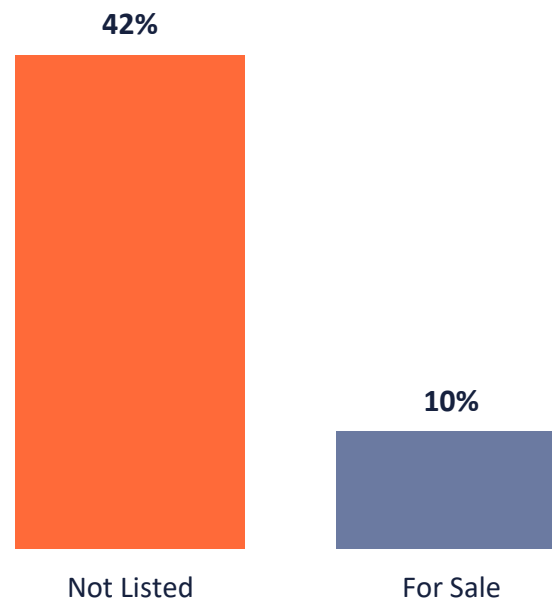
*Organic search compounds. Social attention doesn't
always convert to paying demand.*

Startups Listed For Sale Are Bigger — and Slowing Down

Median MRR (\$)



Mean MRR Growth (30d)



5.6×

higher MRR for listed
vs. unlisted startups

14%

of listings report
\$0 in MRR

*Diligence the growth trend, not just the
trailing revenue figure.*

The Most Successful Founders Are Often Invisible

Median MRR: Named vs. Anonymous “Stealth” Startups

“Stealth” Startups (13%)



\$7,337

Named Startups (87%)



\$185

40×

revenue premium for
anonymous listings

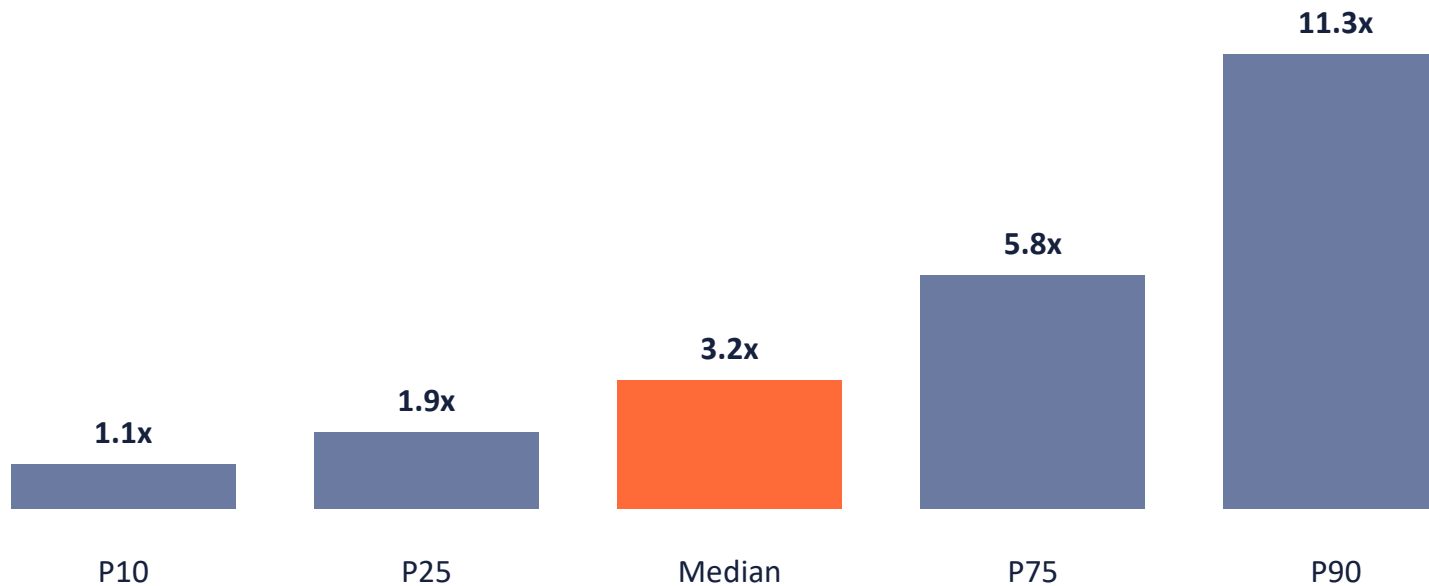
129

startups (13%) list as
“Stealth Company”

*Public “build-in-public” benchmarks likely understate
the real performance ceiling.*

Fair Value Clusters at 2–6× Annual MRR

Asking-Price Multiple of Annualized MRR, by Percentile



3.2×

median deal multiple

1.9–5.8×

fair-value band
(IQR)

694×

max observed —
a pricing red flag,
not a benchmark

SO WHAT

What This Means For Founders and Investors

FOR FOUNDERS

- Chase the momentum threshold — not steady linear growth
- Invest in SEO over social audience-building
- Favor B2B or hybrid positioning where the product allows it

FOR INVESTORS & ACQUIRERS

- Benchmark on percentiles, never on the average
- Weight growth trajectory over trailing revenue in diligence
- Anchor pricing to the 1.9–5.8× MRR band; treat outliers as a red flag

What's visible is not what's winning — underwrite accordingly.